

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 9
♥ 10 9 8 2
♦ K 9 3
♣ A 8 4

♠ A 8 2
♥ A K 6
♦ A Q J 7
♣ K 6 2



♠ 10 6 5 3
♥ Q 7 4
♦ 10 8
♣ J 9 5 3

♠ Q 7 4
♥ J 5 3
♦ 6 5 4 2
♣ Q 10 7

West	North	East	South
	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♣3, West plays the ♣A.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 6

You have the possibility of one additional ♠ winner if East holds the ♠K. However, ♦s is your best suit and if West holds the ♦K you could gain all three winners that you need from that suit. But of course you need perhaps 2 dummy entries. Do you have them?

Well, you probably do. East's small ♣ lead probably indicates an honor, and with West playing the ♣A you can be pretty sure that East holds the ♣J. So by playing your ♣K underneath the ♣A you set up a second entry to dummy via the ♣ finesse.

Assume West now plays a ♥. Take your ♥A and play a ♣ to dummy's ♣10. Lead a ♦ and finesse the ♦J, which holds. Play another ♣ to dummy and finesse another ♦. Now play your ♦A and smile when the ♦K drops and your fourth ♦ becomes a winner.

As soon as West put up the ♣A you knew you could win 2 ♣ tricks.

By unblocking the ♣K you were still pretty confident that you would get the two tricks, but the bonus was in the extra dummy entry your unblock created.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q J
 ♥ A Q 6
 ♦ 8 4
 ♣ Q J 9 8 5 3

♠ A 6 4
 ♥ 9 7 4 2
 ♦ Q 10 6
 ♣ K 7 4



♠ K 10 9 8 3
 ♥ K J
 ♦ K 7 3
 ♣ A 10 2

♠ 7 5 2
 ♥ 10 8 5 3
 ♦ A J 9 5 2
 ♣ 6

West	North	East	South
		1 ♠	Pass
2 ♣	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by East			
when North plays low. Play one more ♣ to your ♣A, picking up North's ♣K this time.			

The ♣ suit is ready to run, so play your ♥K to dummy's ♥A and take your ♣ winners. You took 9 tricks in all, the ♦K, the ♥A Q and all 6 ♣s.

You started with 3 ♥ winners, but had to sacrifice one of them to get the second entry to dummy.

Since it gave you all 6 ♣ tricks the sacrifice was well worth it.

East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♦5, North plays the ♦Q.

Winners: ♠=0 ♥=3 ♦=1 ♣=1 Total = 5

You must take the ♦K right now or you might lose the first 5 tricks.

It's a shame about that solid ♠ suit, but if you try to win even a single ♠ they will grab the ♠A and win enough ♦ tricks to set the contract.

So you are going to have to win a lot of ♣ tricks, and do so without losing the lead. You need dummy entries, and they must be in ♥s.

Win the ♦K. Play the ♥J to dummy's ♥Q. Play the ♣Q and when North follows with a low card let it ride. Still in dummy, play the ♣J, again letting it ride.